

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Construction and Architecture English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For architects, construction managers, project engineers, site supervisors, estimators, owners' representatives, subcontractor coordinators, and design-build teams.

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Design Intent and Client Requirements

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

03 Change Orders and Cost Control

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

04 Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

05 Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Clarify missing information before responding.

06 Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

07 Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

08 Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Design Intent and Client Requirements

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A client describes a meeting space as "flexible" but has not specified occupancy, furniture changes, or audiovisual needs.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

design intent - Functional, aesthetic, performance, and user objectives the design must preserve as details are developed.

program - In architecture, a statement of required spaces, functions, and user needs; elsewhere, an organized set of activities.

constructability - Extent to which a design can be built safely, efficiently, and reliably using available methods, materials, and sequencing.

scope - Defined boundary of work, responsibility, deliverables, assumptions, and exclusions.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Flexible for which activities?

Fictional design briefing: a client requests a flexible meeting room but has not specified occupancy, furniture changes, or audiovisual requirements.

01 • Architect: Your brief calls the meeting room flexible. Which activities should that flexibility support?

02 • Client facilities manager: We want presentations and small-group discussions, but haven't agreed attendance numbers for either.

03 • Architect: Could you confirm who can define the occupancy requirements before we develop the room program?

04 • Client facilities manager: Our events lead can do that. I shouldn't give you a number based on my guess.

05 • Architect: Thank you. Do you expect staff to move furniture between sessions, or keep one arrangement?

06 • Client facilities manager: That is still undecided. Would those choices affect the design intent and equipment requirements?

07 • Architect: Yes. They affect what we need to investigate, including furniture, audiovisual needs, and constructability.

08 • Client facilities manager: Then let's separate the known activities from the unresolved operational requirements in the scope.

09 • Architect: Agreed. Please ask the events lead about attendance and changeovers; I'll gather the audiovisual questions.

10 • Client facilities manager: I'll return with confirmed requirements rather than treating flexible as a complete specification.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Accessible to whom, for what use?

Separate fictional early-design case: a museum client requests an accessible staff workshop; detailed user requirements and specialist review are not yet available.

01 • Project architect: The program says accessible workshop. Could you clarify the activities and users we should plan for?

02 • Museum operations manager: Staff will prepare exhibits there, but we haven't collected their equipment or access requirements.

03 • Project architect: Then we should gather those requirements before assuming a particular layout meets everyone's needs.

04 • Museum operations manager: Can we just copy the workshop at our other site and call that compliant?

05 • Project architect: A copied layout wouldn't establish compliance or suitability here. Those questions need project-specific qualified review.

06 • Museum operations manager: What information should I request from the exhibit team first to clarify the scope?

07 • Project architect: Ask about tasks, equipment, movement, and stated access needs, using the appropriate consultation process.

08 • Museum operations manager: I'll avoid inferring what individuals need from their job titles or appearances.

09 • Project architect: Good. We'll use the confirmed requirements to develop design intent and identify remaining specialist questions.

10 • Museum operations manager: I'll arrange that discussion before presenting the copied layout as an agreed solution.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Open plan does not mean no storage

Separate fictional office brief: a client wants an open-plan reception area; storage quantity and privacy needs remain unspecified.

01 • Interior architect: When you say open plan, do you mean clear sightlines or removing every enclosed space?

02 • Client project manager: Mainly clear sightlines from reception. We still need storage, but haven't agreed how much.

03 • Interior architect: That's an important distinction. What materials will be stored, and who needs access during opening hours?

04 • Client project manager: The reception team holds supplies and visitor materials. I need to confirm volumes with them.

05 • Interior architect: Could you also check whether any conversations need privacy near the reception desk?

06 • Client project manager: Yes. I had assumed open plan meant privacy wasn't part of the scope.

07 • Interior architect: We shouldn't assume that. The room program can distinguish visual openness from functional privacy requirements.

08 • Client project manager: I'll ask the team about both before approving the concept's design intent.

09 • Interior architect: Then I'll develop options against those confirmed needs, rather than simply removing the enclosed storage.

10 • Client project manager: Agreed. Our next discussion will clarify the requirements before we commit to a layout.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Design Intent and Client Requirements

A client describes a meeting space as "flexible" but has not specified occupancy, furniture changes, or audiovisual needs.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: What activities should the space support, and how often will the layout change? Let's clarify occupancy and equipment needs so the design brief gives the team a usable direction.

Scenario 2 | A robust finish needs a use case

A fictional community center brief asks for a robust lobby finish. The lobby receives wheeled deliveries twice weekly, but cleaning methods and appearance preferences are unknown. Clarify what the client means before selecting materials.

Role A: Architect: ask about the intended performance and missing maintenance requirements.

Role B: Facilities coordinator: confirm the delivery use and agree to obtain cleaning information.

Possible opening: When you say robust, which types of wear should the lobby finish be designed to accommodate?

Success checks

- Use the known delivery activity to focus the questions.
- Identify missing maintenance information.
- Avoid presenting an unreviewed material as the final design.

Add a complication: The coordinator asks you to name a final material before maintenance requirements are known.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A drawing and specification appear to describe different finishes for the same area. The site team needs a documented clarification.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

RFI - Request for information used to resolve an ambiguity, conflict, or missing detail in contract documents or a project scope.

specification - A detailed statement of required characteristics, performance, or materials.

drawing set - The collection of drawings that describes a design or construction project.

submittal - Information supplied by a contractor for required review, such as product data or shop drawings.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
 - B. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - C. Send it no later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
 - B. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - C. Could you confirm that the review is important?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two finish descriptions for one corridor

Fictional project coordination: drawing A14 and specification section F2 describe different corridor finishes; neither precedence nor a final selection is established.

01 • Site coordinator: Drawing A14 shows one corridor finish, but specification section F2 describes a different one.

02 • Architectural coordinator: Please raise a request for information identifying the corridor and both document references.

03 • Site coordinator: Could you confirm the required finish before we tell the subcontractor what to order?

04 • Architectural coordinator: I'll route the RFI for an authorized response. I can't resolve the conflict from this summary alone.

05 • Site coordinator: Would using the drawing automatically settle it because the site team normally reads drawings first?

06 • Architectural coordinator: No. Reading habits don't establish document precedence or the project's approved finish selection.

07 • Site coordinator: I'll include the drawing set revision and relevant specification excerpt so the reviewer can compare them.

08 • Architectural coordinator: Good. Explain that procurement needs clarification, and ask when a reviewed response can be provided.

09 • Site coordinator: I'll keep the related submittal pending rather than describe either finish as approved.

10 • Architectural coordinator: That makes the request actionable and preserves the unresolved selection until the proper response arrives.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The submittal refers to a missing revision

Separate fictional case: a product submittal cites drawing revision C, while the coordination folder contains only revision B; procurement has not been authorized.

01 • Procurement coordinator: This submittal cites revision C, but our drawing set only includes revision B.

02 • Document controller: Could you send the submittal reference so I can check whether C was issued to this team?

03 • Procurement coordinator: I'll provide it. We need the applicable drawing before checking the product against the design.

04 • Document controller: Agreed. A revision letter in a supplier document doesn't establish that the drawing was formally issued.

05 • Procurement coordinator: Can I ask the supplier to change the letter to B and keep the review moving?

06 • Document controller: Not without clarification. That might conceal a genuine design change or an incorrect reference.

07 • Procurement coordinator: Then please verify the issued revision and identify who can clarify the submittal's basis.

08 • Document controller: I'll check the register and report what is available, including any missing transmission record.

09 • Procurement coordinator: I'll tell the review team why procurement remains pending instead of treating the mismatch as cosmetic.

10 • Document controller: Good. We'll preserve both references and resolve the document question through the project's review process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Request a dimension without inventing one

Separate fictional coordination case: a joinery drawing omits a counter dimension needed for a shop-drawing review; no site measurement is supplied.

01 • Joinery coordinator: The counter depth is missing from drawing J6. Could you obtain the design dimension for our review?

02 • Design manager: Which counter and revision are you checking? The request needs to identify the exact missing information.

03 • Joinery coordinator: The reception counter on J6, revision A. Its depth isn't labeled in the drawing provided.

04 • Design manager: Please put those references in the RFI and explain that the shop-drawing review depends on clarification.

05 • Joinery coordinator: Could we scale it from the image and use that as the approved dimension?

06 • Design manager: We shouldn't turn an estimate from an image into an authorized design requirement.

07 • Joinery coordinator: Understood. I'll request the dimension and ask when the responsible designer can respond.

08 • Design manager: If the review timing is affected, state that impact without inventing a guaranteed response date.

09 • Joinery coordinator: I'll keep the submittal's dimension check open and note that no verified dimension is available.

10 • Design manager: That is a clear request: exact location, missing information, purpose, and a realistic timing question.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

A drawing and specification appear to describe different finishes for the same area. The site team needs a documented clarification.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could the design team confirm the intended finish and relevant revision? I'll identify the conflicting references in a request for information rather than assume which instruction takes precedence.

Scenario 2 | A finish sample has no room reference

A fictional finish sample is labeled approved color but gives no room or drawing reference. Two rooms have different scheduled colors. Ask the design coordinator to identify the intended location before the sample is used for a submittal.

Role A: Site administrator: identify the sample's missing location reference and its effect on review.

Role B: Design coordinator: agree to check the approval record rather than guess the room.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which room this approved-color sample belongs to before we use it in the submittal?

Success checks

- Name the missing room and document link.
- Explain why the distinction affects the submittal.
- Keep both room selections unaltered pending clarification.

Add a complication: The subcontractor wants to use it in both rooms to avoid waiting.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Change Orders and Cost Control

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A client requests an additional partition after pricing is agreed. Cost and schedule effects have not been assessed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

change order - A documented modification to agreed construction work, often affecting price or time.

allowance - An amount included in a construction budget for an item not yet fully specified.

contingency - A possible future condition or provision for it; in contracts, a condition affecting the transaction.

notice - A formal communication informing a party about an event, requirement, or proposed action.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Compare this wording: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changes, we reviewed the schedule.
 - B. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - C. If the scope will change, we will review the schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.
 - B. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - C. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Price the partition before promising it

Fictional change discussion: a client requests an extra partition after pricing is agreed; cost and schedule effects are unassessed.

01 • Client representative: Could you add another partition and still finish for the agreed price and date?

02 • Project manager: We can assess the addition, but neither its cost nor schedule effect has been reviewed.

03 • Client representative: There is a contingency in the budget. Doesn't that mean this change is already covered?

04 • Project manager: A contingency doesn't establish approval for this particular change or eliminate its possible timing effect.

05 • Client representative: What options can I take to the client team without promising something you can't deliver?

06 • Project manager: We can keep the agreed scope or seek a priced change order for the partition.

07 • Client representative: If we choose the review, does that authorize you to start the extra work?

08 • Project manager: No. Assessment and authorization remain separate under this project's change process.

09 • Client representative: I'll request the assessment and ask the client to decide after seeing cost and schedule implications.

10 • Project manager: I'll document the request and applicable notice steps without guaranteeing an unchanged budget or completion date.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An allowance is not a fixed supplier quote

Separate fictional case: a lobby project has a lighting allowance, and a client proposes a fixture that has not been quoted or reviewed.

01 • Client project lead: Can we select this feature light today? The budget already includes a lighting allowance.

02 • Cost consultant: The allowance is a budget provision, not a verified quote for this particular fixture.

03 • Client project lead: Then what can we decide now without delaying the entire design discussion this afternoon?

04 • Cost consultant: You can nominate it for review, while retaining the current selection as the comparison option.

05 • Client project lead: Would the review include supply timing as well as the purchase price from the vendor?

06 • Cost consultant: Yes, we should compare relevant cost and schedule effects before recommending a change.

07 • Client project lead: If it fits the allowance, can I tell the team the change order is automatically approved?

08 • Cost consultant: No. Budget fit doesn't replace the project's approval process or confirm all associated costs.

09 • Client project lead: I'll present it as a preferred candidate, conditional on the assessment and authorized approval.

10 • Cost consultant: I'll request the necessary information and keep the existing approved scope distinct from this proposal.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A phased change needs defined boundaries

Separate fictional case: a client requests repainting three additional rooms; the contractor can assess all three together or assess one priority room first. No extra work is approved.

01 • Facilities client: We want three more rooms repainted, but one is needed sooner than the others.

02 • Contract administrator: We can assess all three together or review the priority room first as a separate proposal.

03 • Facilities client: Would reviewing one first guarantee that it finishes before the original project handover date?

04 • Contract administrator: No. We still need the scope, access, cost, and schedule assessment for that room.

05 • Facilities client: Then I'd prefer the priority-room assessment first, provided the other two aren't silently removed.

06 • Contract administrator: We can record all three requests and identify the first room as the assessment priority.

07 • Facilities client: Does that mean the remaining rooms are included in the original contract allowance?

08 • Contract administrator: No inclusion is established. Each requested addition remains subject to the agreed change-order process.

09 • Facilities client: I'll explain that sequencing the assessment is different from approving the work or its funding.

10 • Contract administrator: Good. I'll record the bounded request and ask when the reviewing team can provide an assessment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Change Orders and Cost Control

A client requests an additional partition after pricing is agreed. Cost and schedule effects have not been assessed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: We can review the partition as a proposed change. Let's assess its cost and schedule effect through the agreed change process before confirming that it is included in the current price.

Scenario 2 | Add a presentation, not an entire redesign

A fictional architecture client requests a second stakeholder presentation outside the agreed one-presentation scope. The team can assess a repeat of existing material or a revised presentation, but no extra fee or date is approved. Negotiate which option to assess.

Role A: Design project manager: distinguish repeating material from creating new design content.

Role B: Client coordinator: choose a proposal and identify the approval still required.

Possible opening: We can assess a repeat presentation or a revised version; the extra scope and timing still need agreement.

Success checks

- Define the two different scopes.
- Identify the added layout request as a further change.
- Keep fees, dates, and authorization conditional on review.

Add a complication: The client asks for new layout options as part of the repeat presentation.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A delivery delay affects a task on the current critical path. A lookahead schedule still shows the original sequence.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

critical path - Sequence of dependent work that determines the shortest feasible timeline.

float - The amount a scheduled activity can move without delaying a specified project milestone under the schedule model.

lookahead schedule - A detailed plan for work expected in the near term.

resequencing - Changing the planned order of activities.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team has completed the review.
 - B. The team is completing the review.
 - C. The team plans to complete the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - B. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - C. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The lookahead still shows the old delivery

Fictional scheduling exercise: a delayed delivery affects a task on the current critical path; the lookahead has not been updated and recovery options are unassessed.

01 • Planner: The delivery delay affects a critical-path task, but our lookahead still shows the original sequence.

02 • Site manager: Have you completed the revised schedule, or are you only identifying the impact at this stage?

03 • Planner: I've identified the affected task. The revised sequence and any recovery options remain under review.

04 • Site manager: Can I tell the client that resequencing will protect the original completion date?

05 • Planner: Not yet. We haven't established a workable recovery plan or its effect on the critical path.

06 • Site manager: What can we say now that is more useful than simply reporting a supplier delay?

07 • Planner: The delivery is delayed, the current sequence is affected, and the lookahead revision is pending.

08 • Site manager: Please identify the review owner and keep any available float separate from an assumed recovery.

09 • Planner: I'll own the scheduling review and ask the delivery team for a verified arrival update.

10 • Site manager: Good. The next briefing should distinguish completed impact identification from the unresolved recovery assessment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Available float is not approved resequencing

Separate fictional project case: a planner identifies two days of float on an internal finish task; a proposed resequence still needs coordination review.

01 • Construction manager: This finish task has two days of float. Can we announce the revised sequence as approved?

02 • Scheduler: No. I've checked the current schedule allowance, but the proposed resequencing still needs coordination review.

03 • Construction manager: What remains open if the schedule already shows that amount of flexibility for the task?

04 • Scheduler: The affected teams haven't confirmed access and dependencies. Float alone doesn't resolve those practical questions.

05 • Construction manager: Then the completed item is your schedule check, not agreement by everyone involved in the change.

06 • Scheduler: Exactly. The lookahead can show the proposal clearly, but shouldn't present it as the agreed plan.

07 • Construction manager: Could we omit the pending status to avoid confusing the subcontractors during tomorrow's briefing?

08 • Scheduler: That would create greater confusion if they act on a sequence nobody has accepted.

09 • Construction manager: I'll ask the coordinators for their responses and describe the two-day float as a current schedule finding.

10 • Scheduler: I'll update the lookahead after those reviews and preserve any unresolved dependencies in the status summary.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Delivered material, unfinished readiness check

Separate fictional case: ceiling panels have arrived, but the area-readiness review for their scheduled task remains open.

01 • Logistics coordinator: The ceiling panels arrived this morning. Is the related lookahead task now ready to proceed?

02 • Site planner: Delivery is complete, but the area-readiness review is still open with the responsible team.

03 • Logistics coordinator: The progress slide currently says all constraints removed. That seems broader than the delivery update.

04 • Site planner: It is. We should correct it to separate material availability from the unresolved readiness check.

05 • Logistics coordinator: Would that mean the delivery wasn't useful progress after all for the critical-path discussion?

06 • Site planner: It is useful progress. It just doesn't establish that every dependency for the task is resolved.

07 • Logistics coordinator: I'll confirm the received quantity in our record and leave the readiness decision to its owner.

08 • Site planner: Thank you. I'll ask that team for its status before revising the sequence in the lookahead.

09 • Logistics coordinator: So the update is panels delivered, readiness pending, and schedule implications still being checked?

10 • Site planner: Correct. That reports what changed without treating a completed delivery as permission to begin work.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

A delivery delay affects a task on the current critical path. A lookahead schedule still shows the original sequence.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The delayed delivery affects a critical-path task. I'll update the lookahead and show the feasible resequencing options for review instead of leaving the original dates unexplained.

Scenario 2 | A meeting milestone is complete, decisions are not

A fictional coordination meeting has taken place, but two sequencing decisions remain unresolved. The lookahead marks the milestone coordination complete. Give an update explaining the distinction and agree who follows up the decisions.

Role A: Planner: separate the completed meeting from the open sequencing decisions.

Role B: Project manager: ask how the open decisions affect the next schedule update.

Possible opening: The coordination meeting is complete, but two sequencing decisions are still open.

Success checks

- Acknowledge the completed meeting.
- Identify decisions rather than attendance as the remaining work.
- Agree follow-up ownership without inventing a recovery date.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to keep the overall complete label because everyone attended.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

In a toolbox-talk exercise, an instruction says to use "the right protection" without identifying the task or approved requirement.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

PPE - Personal protective equipment selected and used under applicable task-specific safety requirements.

fall protection - Systems and measures used under approved procedures to address the risk of falls from height.

toolbox talk - A short, task-relevant safety discussion conducted under an organization's safety arrangements.

stop work - A call or authorized action to pause work when a safety concern requires attention under local procedures.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which task and approved protection?

Fictional toolbox-talk language exercise: an instruction says use the right protection but identifies neither the task nor its approved requirements; no actual safety method is supplied.

01 • Site trainee: The toolbox talk says use the right protection. Could you clarify which task that instruction covers?

02 • Safety coordinator: The task isn't identified in this excerpt, so we need the approved task-specific information.

03 • Site trainee: Can I just name familiar PPE so the rest of the group has an answer?

04 • Safety coordinator: No. Guessing equipment doesn't establish the approved protection for work we haven't even identified.

05 • Site trainee: Who should clarify the task and applicable requirements before this briefing exercise continues?

06 • Safety coordinator: We'll ask the authorized task supervisor for the current approved briefing materials and explanation.

07 • Site trainee: Should we also confirm whether the reference to fall protection belongs to this task?

08 • Safety coordinator: Yes. Ask about the exact reference without treating a general term as a complete instruction.

09 • Site trainee: I'll say the task and requirements remain unclear, rather than claim the briefing is complete.

10 • Safety coordinator: Good. In actual work, the applicable safety and stop-work procedures govern the response to uncertainty.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A protection abbreviation without an explanation

Separate fictional induction exercise: a briefing card contains an unexplained PPE abbreviation; trainees have not been given the task-specific approved instructions.

01 • Induction trainer: The briefing card uses an abbreviation that several trainees couldn't explain during the discussion.

02 • Site supervisor: Which abbreviation is unclear, and does the card identify the task it relates to?

03 • Induction trainer: It appears in the PPE section, but the card doesn't link it to a defined task.

04 • Site supervisor: Then we need both the meaning and the applicable task reference clarified by the authorized source.

05 • Induction trainer: Would expanding the letters alone be enough to mark the toolbox talk as understood?

06 • Site supervisor: No. Recognizing words isn't the same as understanding the approved requirement for a particular activity.

07 • Induction trainer: I'll ask trainees to identify what remains unclear without inviting them to invent a safety method.

08 • Site supervisor: Good. I'll obtain the current briefing material and arrange the appropriate task-specific explanation.

09 • Induction trainer: Afterward, we can ask them to repeat the clarification in their own words for language practice.

10 • Site supervisor: Yes, while making clear that this exercise doesn't authorize work or replace qualified safety instruction.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A changed task needs a clarified briefing

Separate fictional communication exercise: a supervisor's message changes the named work area but repeats an earlier generic protection instruction; actual work follows authorized procedures.

01 • Work coordinator: Your message names a different area, but repeats the earlier protection wording. Is the task unchanged?

02 • Site supervisor: I haven't confirmed that in the message. Thank you for identifying the ambiguity before the briefing.

03 • Work coordinator: Could you clarify the exact task and whether the approved briefing applies to this area?

04 • Site supervisor: I'll check with the responsible safety and task leads rather than assume the earlier instruction transfers.

05 • Work coordinator: Someone suggested saying same PPE as before to keep the toolbox talk short today.

06 • Site supervisor: That would hide the question we need answered. Brevity shouldn't replace the applicable approved information.

07 • Work coordinator: I'll keep the area change and outstanding clarification visible in the coordination note.

08 • Site supervisor: Please do. The note should request clarification, not offer instructions on fall protection or equipment use.

09 • Work coordinator: Once the authorized clarification arrives, I'll ask the receiving team to repeat the relevant status.

10 • Site supervisor: Agreed. Until then, actual activity remains governed by the local safety and stop-work process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

In a toolbox-talk exercise, an instruction says to use "the right protection" without identifying the task or approved requirement.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Which task and approved safety requirement does this refer to? Please have the authorized person clarify the instruction before work proceeds. The language needs to be specific enough to understand and check.

Scenario 2 | The briefing says nearby work

In a fictional toolbox-talk exercise, a notice says nearby work may affect access but names neither the location nor the responsible contact. Ask for those details. No route, protective equipment, or operating method is supplied.

Role A: Site coordinator: identify the missing location and contact before relaying the notice.

Role B: Briefing lead: agree to obtain the authorized clarification without inventing an access route.

Possible opening: Could you clarify where nearby work is taking place and who can explain the approved access arrangements?

Success checks

- Ask precise location and ownership questions.
- Do not recommend an unverified route.
- Keep actual access decisions with the authorized process.

Add a complication: A colleague offers an unofficial shortcut as the solution.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

An inspection note identifies outstanding items, but a progress email says the area is fully approved.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

permit - Official permission for an activity under specified requirements.

inspection - An examination of an item or condition against relevant requirements.

code compliance - Conformity with the applicable building, engineering, or other technical code requirements.

reinspection - An additional inspection, often to check correction of previously identified issues.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - C. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correct the approval claim

Fictional inspection coordination: an inspection note lists outstanding items, but a progress email says the area is fully approved.

01 • Inspection coordinator: Please correct the progress email. The inspection note lists outstanding items, not full approval of the area.

02 • Project administrator: I thought the inspection visit itself meant approval. Which information should the revised message include?

03 • Inspection coordinator: State that the visit occurred and ask the responsible reviewer to confirm each item's status.

04 • Project administrator: Could you provide the note reference so the correction points readers to the actual record?

05 • Inspection coordinator: Yes. Use the inspection record attached to this case, and preserve its outstanding-item wording.

06 • Project administrator: Should I book reinspection immediately and promise approval after that second visit takes place?

07 • Inspection coordinator: Request the applicable next steps, but don't guarantee an inspection outcome or infer code compliance.

08 • Project administrator: I'll ask the authorized coordinator what evidence and arrangements are needed for the next review.

09 • Inspection coordinator: Please also identify who will correct the client-facing status so the two messages agree.

10 • Project administrator: I'll own that correction and describe approval as unresolved until the appropriate confirmation is available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A permit application needs a status source

Separate fictional project case: a permit application has been submitted; the team lacks a current status response and must request one.

01 • Project coordinator: Could you obtain the permit application's current status from the authorized liaison before our client briefing?

02 • Permitting administrator: Do you need confirmation of submission or a decision? The submission receipt is already available.

03 • Project coordinator: The decision status. The receipt doesn't tell us whether the application is approved or still under review.

04 • Permitting administrator: I'll ask the liaison for the current record and any outstanding information requests.

05 • Project coordinator: Please also ask when another update is available if they can't provide a decision status yet.

06 • Permitting administrator: Can we tell the client that submission normally leads to approval within a fixed number of days?

07 • Project coordinator: We don't have that verified information for this case. Avoid a general timeline or guaranteed outcome.

08 • Permitting administrator: I'll keep the request specific to this application and the evidence needed for the briefing.

09 • Project coordinator: Good. Explain that planning needs accurate status, not permission inferred from an acknowledgment email.

10 • Permitting administrator: I'll return the verified response or clearly report that the requested status remains unavailable.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Ask what closes the inspection item

Separate fictional closeout case: a photograph is uploaded against an inspection item, but no reviewer acceptance is recorded.

01 • Site administrator: The contractor uploaded a photograph. Could you confirm what else is required to close the inspection item?

02 • Inspection liaison: We need the responsible reviewer's assessment; an upload alone doesn't establish acceptance of the work.

03 • Site administrator: Should my request identify the photograph and ask whether it addresses the recorded outstanding item?

04 • Inspection liaison: Yes. Include the item reference and ask for the applicable next step if further evidence is needed.

05 • Site administrator: The contractor wants us to call the area compliant now because the image looks satisfactory.

06 • Inspection liaison: We can't make that determination from appearance in this conversation. Keep qualified review and evidence distinct.

07 • Site administrator: I'll ask the reviewer for status and an achievable response point, not demand an unverified approval today.

08 • Inspection liaison: Good. If reinspection is required, the authorized team should confirm the arrangements and scope.

09 • Site administrator: Until then, I'll report evidence submitted and acceptance pending against this specific inspection item.

10 • Inspection liaison: That gives the project team a useful request and avoids turning a photograph into a compliance decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

An inspection note identifies outstanding items, but a progress email says the area is fully approved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you confirm the inspection status and the items still outstanding? I'll correct the progress wording so it does not imply approval that has not been documented.

Scenario 2 | Which inspection area does the notice cover?

A fictional inspection notice names Level 2 but gives no room range. Two separate Level 2 areas are in the project. Ask the inspection liaison to confirm the covered area before coordinating attendance.

Role A: Site coordinator: request the exact inspection boundary and supporting reference.

Role B: Inspection liaison: agree to verify the notice's scope with the authorized source.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which Level 2 area this inspection notice covers so we invite the right team?

Success checks

- Identify the ambiguous area reference.
- Connect the request to attendance coordination.
- Avoid predicting approval or extending the inspection scope.

Add a complication: A manager suggests announcing that both areas will be approved after the visit.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

SITUATION

A closeout list contains eight items, with three completed and five awaiting review. The incoming coordinator needs the supporting records.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

punch list - A list of outstanding construction items requiring completion or correction.

substantial completion - A contract-defined construction stage when work is sufficiently complete for its intended use, subject to applicable terms.

warranty - A promise or contractual assurance about a product or work, with defined terms and remedies.

closeout - The documented completion and transfer of a project's remaining obligations and records.

3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Compare this wording: Someone should follow up on this.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Transfer information and responsibility

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
 - A. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
 - B. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
 - C. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
 - A. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
 - B. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.
 - C. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three complete, five awaiting review

Fictional closeout handoff: a punch list contains eight items, three completed and five awaiting review; the incoming coordinator needs the supporting records.

01 • Outgoing closeout coordinator: The punch list has eight items: three complete and five awaiting review by the responsible team.

02 • Incoming closeout coordinator: I'll take follow-up. Where are the supporting records for the completed and pending items?

03 • Outgoing closeout coordinator: They're linked against each item in the closeout register; the five pending entries retain that status.

04 • Incoming closeout coordinator: Does three complete mean the project has reached substantial completion under the contract?

05 • Outgoing closeout coordinator: That isn't established by this list. We shouldn't infer a contractual milestone from item counts.

06 • Incoming closeout coordinator: Understood. I'll verify the links and contact the review owners about the five open items.

07 • Outgoing closeout coordinator: Please flag any unavailable supporting record instead of assuming an item has accepted evidence.

08 • Incoming closeout coordinator: I'll do that and keep warranty-document questions separate from the physical punch-list checks.

09 • Outgoing closeout coordinator: Can you confirm your responsibility before I pass the coordination record to the next shift?

10 • Incoming closeout coordinator: I accept record checking and review follow-up; five items remain pending, with no broader completion claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Warranty documents still need checking

Separate fictional handoff: equipment manuals are received, but two warranty documents lack matching equipment references; no warranty interpretation is supplied.

01 • Handover administrator: The manuals have arrived, but two warranty documents don't identify the equipment listed in our register.

02 • Facilities handover lead: I'll accept the document follow-up. Have those warranties been checked against the supplier's approved records?

03 • Handover administrator: Not yet. The mismatch is recorded, and I haven't treated receipt as a completed verification.

04 • Facilities handover lead: Good. Could you identify the two documents in the register so I contact the correct supplier?

05 • Handover administrator: Their entries are flagged missing equipment reference, with the received copies linked for review.

06 • Facilities handover lead: I'll request clarification and keep the originals preserved rather than add references based on my guess.

07 • Handover administrator: Please don't tell operations that the warranty coverage is confirmed merely because the files exist.

08 • Facilities handover lead: Agreed. Any interpretation belongs with the relevant documents and qualified reviewer, not this handoff.

09 • Handover administrator: So manuals are received, two warranty checks remain open, and you own supplier clarification?

10 • Facilities handover lead: Confirmed. I'll report verified changes in the closeout status and keep unresolved document questions visible.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A rejected handoff needs reassignment

Separate fictional closeout case: a quality coordinator cannot accept five review follow-ups because they are leaving the project; the project manager must arrange ownership.

01 • Closeout administrator: I sent five punch-list review requests to the quality coordinator, but they cannot take them over.

02 • Project manager: Then the handoff isn't accepted. Who currently owns follow-up while we arrange a receiving person?

03 • Closeout administrator: I still own the coordination. Sending the requests hasn't transferred that responsibility to another team.

04 • Project manager: Please keep that clear in the closeout register. I'll arrange an authorized reassignment for the reviews.

05 • Closeout administrator: Should I remove the outgoing coordinator's name before a replacement has agreed to the work?

06 • Project manager: Record the declined handoff and pending reassignment without hiding the ownership gap or current coordination owner.

07 • Closeout administrator: I can keep the supporting records ready and explain the open items to the new recipient.

08 • Project manager: Good. No item should be labeled complete simply because its original reviewer is no longer available.

09 • Closeout administrator: I'll maintain the pending statuses and ask the new recipient to repeat back the accepted responsibilities.

10 • Project manager: I'll confirm the reassignment when accepted, so the next handoff has both evidence and an identifiable owner.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

A closeout list contains eight items, with three completed and five awaiting review. The incoming coordinator needs the supporting records.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Three items are complete, and five await review. The list links each item to its record and responsible party. Please confirm the remaining review steps before reporting closeout as finished.

Scenario 2 | One closeout link is broken

A fictional closeout register lists four accepted items, but one supporting-record link no longer opens. Acceptance is recorded; the evidence copy must be retrieved. Hand over retrieval without assuming the work must be redone or the evidence never existed.

Role A: Outgoing administrator: state the recorded acceptance and inaccessible link separately.

Role B: Incoming coordinator: accept retrieval and confirm the document reference to investigate.

Possible opening: Acceptance is recorded for this item, but its supporting-record link is unavailable and needs retrieval.

Success checks

- Separate work status from document availability.
- Avoid unsupported conclusions about missing evidence.
- Confirm who owns retrieval and the next status update.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to erase the accepted status solely because the link is broken.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A project team wants to say a delay automatically entitles it to compensation. The contract and records have not been reviewed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

claim - A statement that may need evidence, approval, qualification, or disclosure before it is used externally.

daily report - A dated record of work, conditions, events, or progress during a day.

meeting minutes - A written record of key discussion points, decisions, and agreed actions.

entitlement - A right to a benefit or remedy under applicable rules or an agreement.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A delay does not establish entitlement

Fictional project discussion: a delay is recorded, but the contract and supporting records have not been reviewed for compensation entitlement.

01 • Project manager: The delivery was late, so our claim automatically entitles us to compensation from the supplier.

02 • Contracts coordinator: The delay is recorded, but entitlement hasn't been established through review of the contract and evidence.

03 • Project manager: The daily report shows the late arrival. Isn't that enough to settle our position?

04 • Contracts coordinator: It supports an observation about timing. It doesn't by itself resolve contractual responsibility or compensation.

05 • Project manager: What can we say in the internal briefing without weakening the documented facts?

06 • Contracts coordinator: State the recorded delay and explain that its effects and contractual implications remain under review.

07 • Project manager: Should we still collect meeting minutes and related correspondence for the authorized reviewer?

08 • Contracts coordinator: Yes. Preserve relevant records and identify gaps rather than filling them with an assumed narrative.

09 • Project manager: I'll describe a potential claim for review, not a guaranteed entitlement or recovery amount.

10 • Contracts coordinator: That keeps the evidence clear while leaving legal and contractual conclusions to the appropriate qualified review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Meeting attendance is not agreement

Separate fictional dispute case: meeting minutes record discussion of a proposed delay allocation but no explicit acceptance; a manager calls it an agreed settlement.

01 • Commercial manager: Everyone attended the meeting, so the minutes prove they accepted our proposed delay allocation.

02 • Project records lead: The minutes record discussion, but they don't record explicit acceptance of that proposal.

03 • Commercial manager: Nobody objected in the version I have. Doesn't silence establish agreement for our claim?

04 • Project records lead: We shouldn't infer that here. Attendance and missing objections aren't the same as documented acceptance.

05 • Commercial manager: Then how should I describe the meeting when sending the record for contract review?

06 • Project records lead: Say the proposal was discussed and that the available minutes don't establish an agreed outcome.

07 • Commercial manager: Could I update the minutes now to say accepted, since that's what I remember?

08 • Project records lead: Don't rewrite the record as settled fact. Use the applicable correction process and attribute your recollection clearly.

09 • Commercial manager: I'll preserve the existing minutes and ask the reviewer which further records are needed.

10 • Project records lead: Good. The claim discussion should separate what the document records from interpretations still in dispute.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Missing daily reports limit the timeline

Separate fictional claims review: daily reports exist for Monday and Wednesday, but Tuesday's report is unavailable; the team is reconstructing a delay chronology.

01 • Delay analyst: Monday and Wednesday reports are available, but Tuesday's report is missing from the review folder.

02 • Commercial coordinator: Can we assume Tuesday followed the same sequence as Monday and finish the chronology?

03 • Delay analyst: No. That would add an unverified event to the record and make the timeline look complete.

04 • Commercial coordinator: What can the claim summary say about that day without implying nothing happened?

05 • Delay analyst: It can state that Tuesday's daily report is unavailable and the day's sequence remains unverified.

06 • Commercial coordinator: I'll ask document control for retrieval and check whether other contemporaneous records can help the reviewer.

07 • Delay analyst: Good. Label any alternative source and distinguish its observations from conclusions about delay entitlement.

08 • Commercial coordinator: Should the missing report itself be described as proof that another party concealed information?

09 • Delay analyst: No. We haven't established why it's unavailable, much less anyone's intention or responsibility.

10 • Commercial coordinator: I'll preserve that uncertainty and send the verified chronology with its explicit gap for qualified review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

A project team wants to say a delay automatically entitles it to compensation. The contract and records have not been reviewed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The delay and its effects should be documented, but entitlement requires appropriate contract and legal review. I'll separate the factual record from any conclusion about a claim.

Scenario 2 | A cost estimate is not an awarded claim

A fictional project team estimates disruption costs at 12,000 units. The calculation has not been reviewed and no claim has been accepted. Explain the status in a meeting with the project director.

Role A: Commercial analyst: distinguish an estimated amount from verified loss and established entitlement.

Role B: Project director: ask what evidence and review are needed before discussing recovery.

Possible opening: The 12,000 figure is an unreviewed estimate, not an accepted claim or guaranteed recovery.

Success checks

- Label the figure as an unreviewed estimate.
- Separate calculation, entitlement, and recovery.
- Agree a qualified review without predicting its outcome.

Add a complication: The director wants to include the amount as confirmed incoming funds in a project slide.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Design Intent and Client Requirements

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: What activities should the space support, and how often will the layout change? Let's clarify occupancy and equipment needs so the design brief gives the team a usable direction.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: C - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

B: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

C: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

Check 2: B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

B: The requested action and information are explicit.

C: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

Model response: Could the design team confirm the intended finish and relevant revision? I'll identify the conflicting references in a request for information rather than assume which instruction takes precedence.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Change Orders and Cost Control

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: B - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: "Reviewed" places the response in the past instead of expressing the future response.

B: The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

C: For this ordinary future condition, use present simple in the "if" clause.

Check 2: A - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

B: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

C: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

Model response: We can review the partition as a proposed change. Let's assess its cost and schedule effect through the agreed change process before confirming that it is included in the current price.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: A - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

B: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

C: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

Check 2: C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

B: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

C: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

Model response: The delayed delivery affects a critical-path task. I'll update the lookahead and show the feasible resequencing options for review instead of leaving the original dates unexplained.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: Which task and approved safety requirement does this refer to? Please have the authorized person clarify the instruction before work proceeds. The language needs to be specific enough to understand and check.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

C: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

Model response: Could you confirm the inspection status and the items still outstanding? I'll correct the progress wording so it does not imply approval that has not been documented.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Check 1: A - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

B: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

C: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

Check 2: C - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: It changes pending information into a final result.

B: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

C: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

Model response: Three items are complete, and five await review. The list links each item to its record and responsible party. Please confirm the remaining review steps before reporting closeout as finished.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: The delay and its effects should be documented, but entitlement requires appropriate contract and legal review. I'll separate the factual record from any conclusion about a claim.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Construction and Architecture English

Professional audience: architects, construction managers, project engineers, site supervisors, estimators, owners' representatives, subcontractor coordinators, and design-build teams

Scope: These cases practice communication. Actual equipment, construction, and safety work follows approved procedures and authorized specialist decisions.

Lesson 01: Design Intent and Client Requirements

Original fictional case: A client describes a meeting space as "flexible" but has not specified occupancy, furniture changes, or audiovisual needs.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: design intent: Functional, aesthetic, performance, and user objectives the design must preserve as details are developed. / program: In architecture, a statement of required spaces, functions, and user needs; elsewhere, an organized set of activities. / constructability: Extent to which a design can be built safely, efficiently, and reliably using available methods, materials, and sequencing. / scope: Defined boundary of work, responsibility, deliverables, assumptions, and exclusions.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: What activities should the space support, and how often will the layout change? Let's clarify occupancy and equipment needs so the design brief gives the team a usable direction.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level